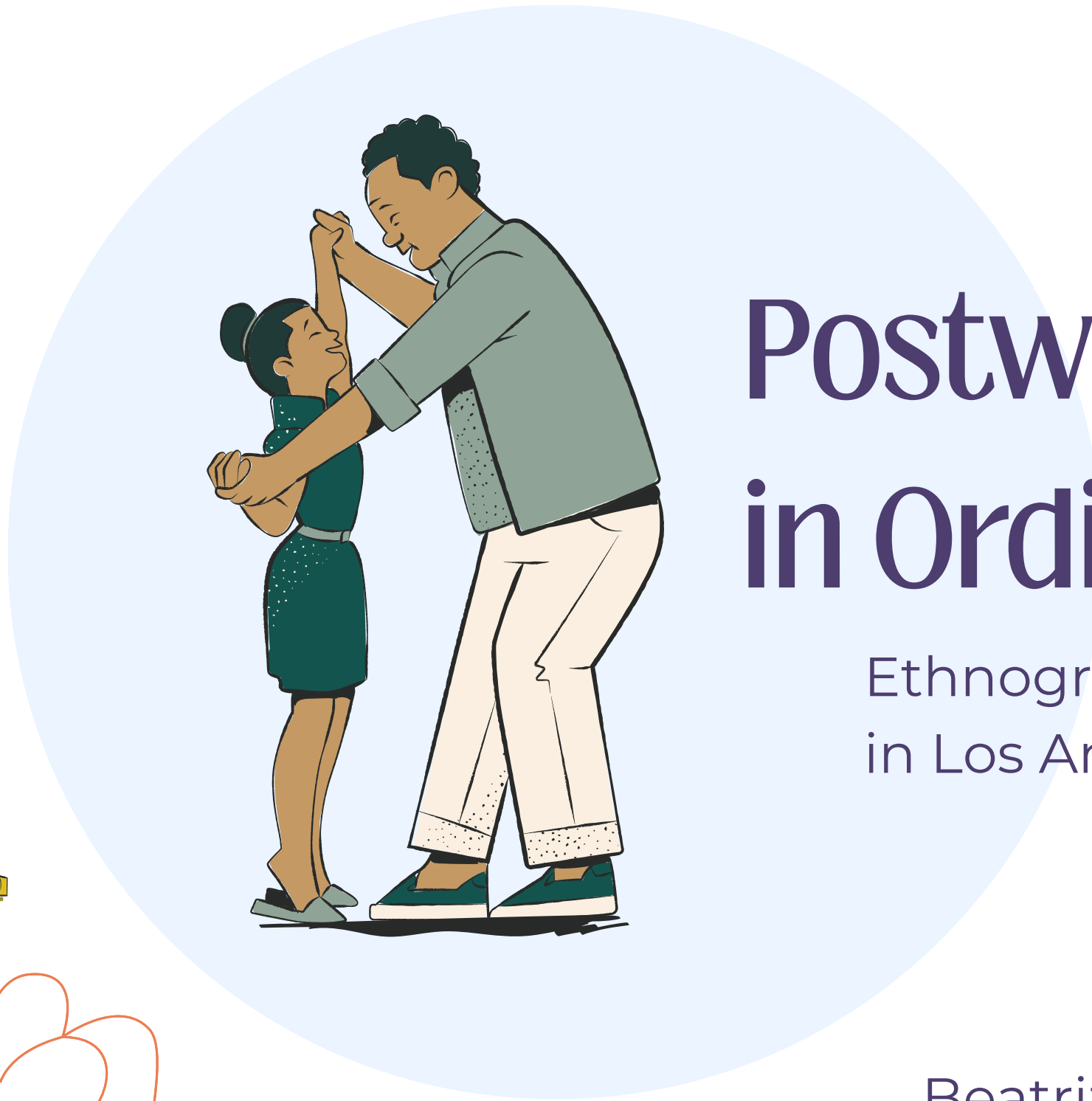
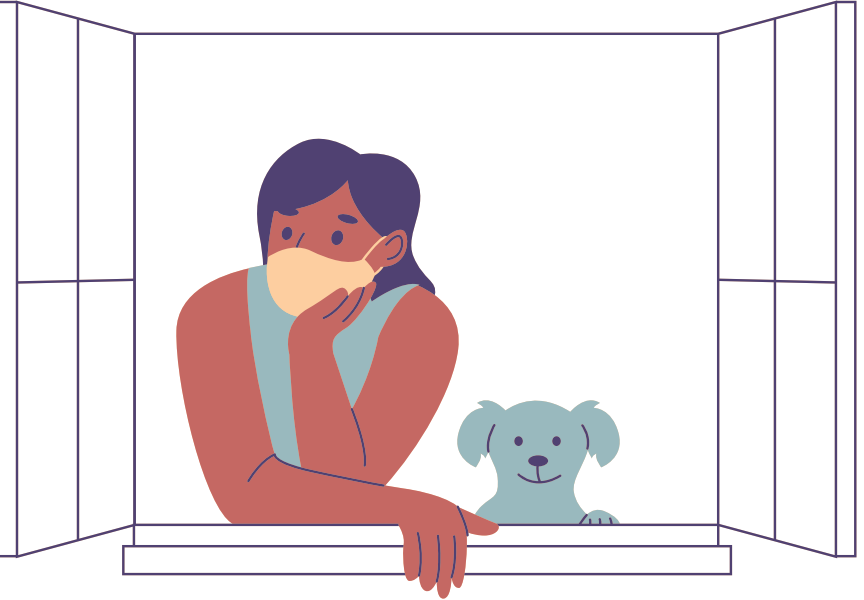


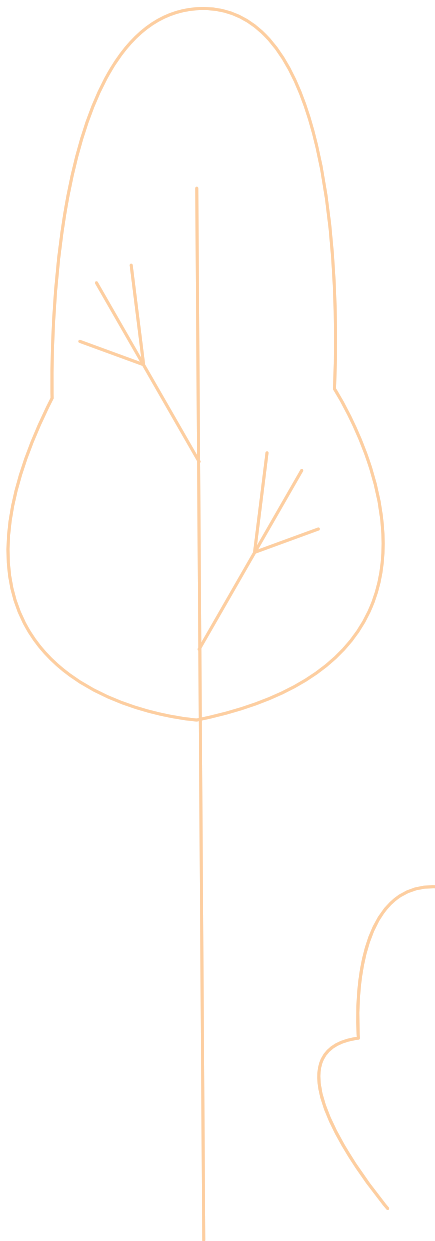


Postwar Stories in Ordinary Life

Ethnographic Research
in Los Angeles

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Ethnography in Los Angeles

How families and communities in the Salvadoran diaspora work to assert, shift into, pursue, and embody notions of “ordinariness” in the context of ongoing violence and exception.



The everyday – while apparently banal, mundane, even dull – actually represents constant movements, charged forces, impulses (Stewart 2007).

Connecting concepts of the ordinary to moments of “impasse;” perpetual crises affectively reframe someone’s life (Berlant 2011).

Ordinariness is a “process... there is always the ‘being ordinary’ but there is also the ‘becoming ordinary’” (Highmore 2010: 6).

Exploring concept of the ordinary







The Exceptional Everyday



- Reflecting on Covid-19 and how the everyday becomes exceptional
- I explore the exceptional everyday as a phenomenon whereby looming and confirmed conditions of death, violence, fears, and anxieties latch onto day-to-day activities and events without a predictable end of exception in sight.

Research Findings

In their ordinary lives, diasporic Salvadorans:

- (Re)produce cultural values and histories
- Share intergenerational knowledges of survival and existence
- Advocate for practices of kinship and belonging
- Adjust to new normals of Covid-19 and the exceptional everyday

Final Reflections

> Identifying User Experiences

- Everyday cultural productions in a community
- Families' perceptions of the ordinary and (extra)ordinary life
- Narratives of violence
- Memory
- Ways of being and becoming
- Multiplicity of life-worlds within migrant communities



Final Reflections

> Identifying User Experiences

- Methodologies and findings reinforce my user experience research expertise:
- Ethnography, field studies, qualitative and quantitative methods, participant observation, data analysis, surveys, interviews, diary studies, Institutional Review Board (IRB) approval for all research projects

